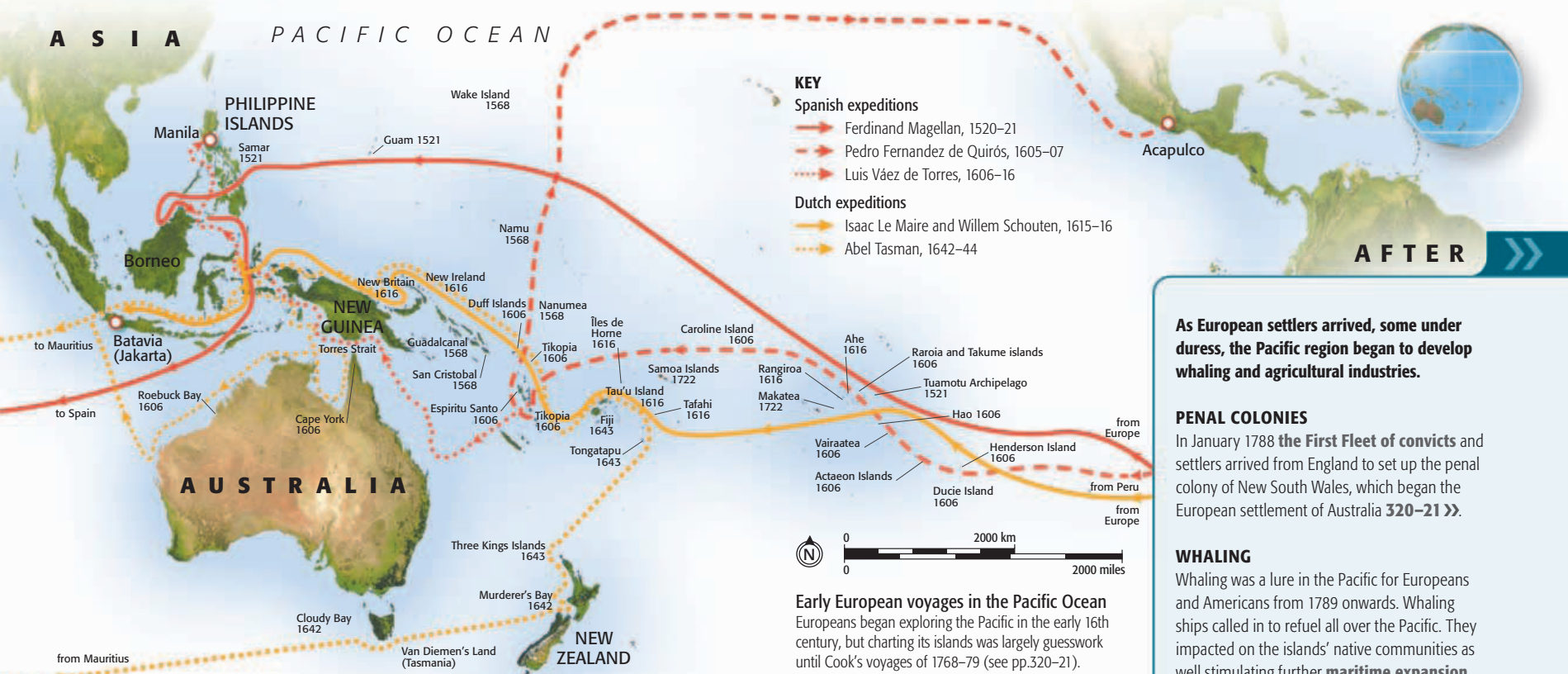




AFTER

As European settlers arrived, some under duress, the Pacific region began to develop whaling and agricultural industries.

PENAL COLONIES

In January 1788 the **First Fleet of convicts** and settlers arrived from England to set up the penal colony of New South Wales, which began the European settlement of Australia **320–21** >>.

WHALING

Whaling was a lure in the Pacific for Europeans and Americans from 1789 onwards. Whaling ships called in to refuel all over the Pacific. They impacted on the islands' native communities as well stimulating further **maritime expansion**.

SHEEP FARMING

British settlers in Australia and New Zealand introduced sheep to temperate regions of the continent. Today, Australia is the **biggest fine-wool producer in the world**.



MERINO SHEEP GRAZING IN AUSTRALIA

properly charted until 1793. Accurate chronometers (see left) were invaluable as they allowed sailors to measure exact longitude for the first time. Other obstacles to colonization included malaria, settlers' reliance on imported livestock, the poor quality of land for farming, and tropical storms.

Spanish monopoly

The biggest disincentive to exploring the Pacific region was reflected in a Dutch East India Company report on Abel Tasman's voyages to Tasmania and New Zealand: "No riches or things of profit, but only the said lands."

The Spanish Empire claimed the exclusive right of navigation in Pacific waters. They used the Pacific primarily to ship South American silver to the Philippines to trade with China and the East Indies. Spain's greatest rival, the Dutch East India Company, concentrated on its possessions in the Indonesian archipelago, discouraging its captains from long, fruitless, and costly ocean voyages in the region. Breakthrough voyages, such as Luis Váez de Torres' 1606 sailing between New Guinea and Australia that proved the former to be an island, received no publicity. The

Spanish did not want Dutch and English ships passing through the Java Sea to the Pacific and on to South America.

The race for land begins

When British Captain James Cook (see pp.320–21) set out for Tahiti on the *Endeavour* in 1768, his orders were to observe the transit of Venus, a rare astronomical event when the planet passes across the disk of the Sun. But the British also wanted to forestall any French ambitions of gaining land in the area. The second, secret purpose of Cook's voyage was to survey the vast Pacific Ocean to see if Tahiti was the possible gateway to the landmass of a southern continent, Australia.

Maori eel trap

A Maori eel trap (*hinaki*) was finely woven from vines and allowed eels to swim in, but not out. It was placed in lakes or waterholes.

